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1. Introduction

This chapter presents the findings of the primary research conducted for this dissertation and addresses the central research question: how do organisations monitor and respond to employees' personal social media activity, and how do employees perceive the fairness and legitimacy of these organisational practices? To address this question, survey data were collected from 63 valid respondents who met the study's participation criteria. The data were analysed using a combination of descriptive statistics, comparative statistical testing, and thematic analysis of open-ended responses to identify overall patterns and areas of nuance. Consistent with the positivist, deductive approach outlined in the research methodology chapter, quantitative findings are reported first before qualitative responses are considered to add depth and context. The chapter begins by outlining the sample profile before presenting quantitative and qualitative findings, followed by discussion, implications, and limitations.

2. Sample Profile

The final dataset consisted of 63 valid respondents, following the exclusion of three responses that did not meet the employment and consent criteria outlined in the methodology. As shown in Appendix A, the sample included respondents from a range of employment contexts, though it was weighted toward the private and public sectors. Of the 63 respondents, 32 (50.8%) worked in the private sector, 24 (38.1%) worked in the public sector, 4 (6.3%) worked in the non-profit sector, and 3 (4.8%) selected other.

The sample was also skewed toward shorter-tenured and non-managerial employees. In terms of tenure, 39.7% of respondents had been with their current or most recent employer for less than one year, and a further 39.7% reported between one and three years, collectively representing 79.4% of the sample with fewer than three years of employment experience. In relation to management level, 49 respondents (77.8%) identified as non-managerial employees, compared with 9 supervisors (14.3%) and 5 middle managers (7.9%), with no senior management respondents. The absence of senior management respondents limits the extent to which cross-hierarchical comparisons can be drawn, which is acknowledged as a constraint on the findings.

While this distribution likely reflects the effects of convenience sampling, the sample provides sufficient variation across sectors and roles to examine employee perceptions meaningfully, and it is these perceptions, beginning with awareness of organisational policies, that the following sections address.

3. Quantitative Findings

3.1 Policy Awareness and Transparency

Awareness of organisational policies and monitoring practices appeared limited across the sample. As shown in Appendix B, almost half of the respondents, 30 (47.6%), reported that their organisation did not have a policy regarding employees' personal social media use, while a further 17 (27%) were unsure. Only 16 respondents (25.4%) confirmed that such a policy existed. Awareness of monitoring was even lower. In response to whether their organisation monitored employees' personal social media activity, 40 respondents (63.5%) answered no, 17 (27%) were unsure, and only 6 (9.5%) answered yes. These findings suggest that most respondents were either unaware of any social media policy or did not believe monitoring was taking place.

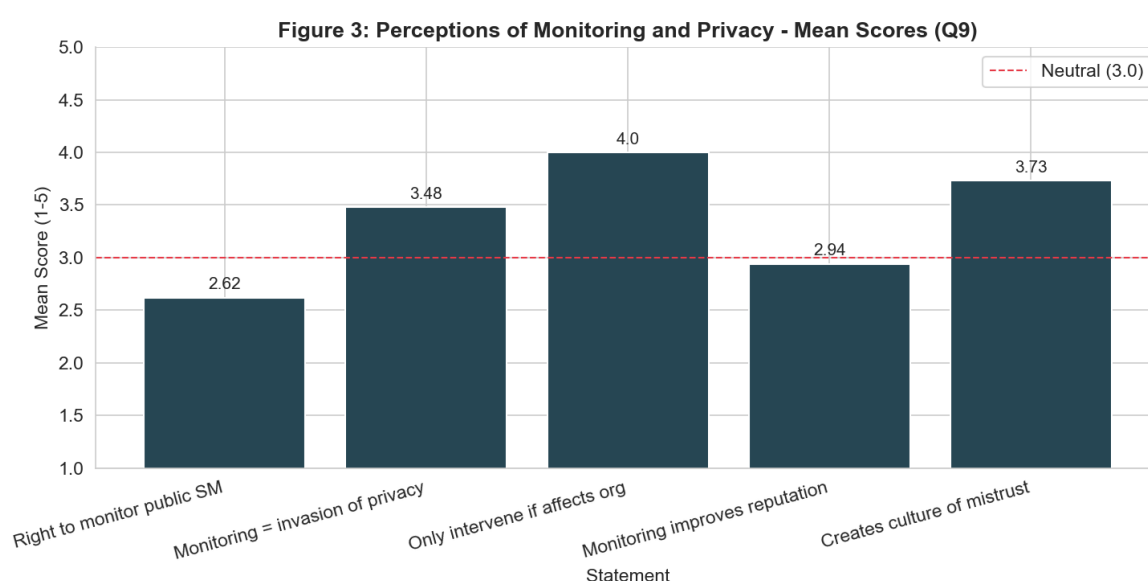
This pattern is broadly consistent with McDonald et al. (2016), who found that fewer than 10% of employees reported having been profiled online, while a substantial proportion were unsure whether such profiling had occurred. At the same time, it also points to a possible gap between organisational practice and employee awareness, particularly when considered alongside Fusi and Feeney's (2018) finding that over one-third of organisations monitored employees' personal social media. This suggests that even where monitoring may occur, it does not appear to be experienced by employees as an open or clearly understood practice.

This interpretation is reinforced by responses to the statement that the organisation's policy on social media use is clearly communicated. The mean score for this statement was 2.48 out of 5, below the neutral midpoint, indicating overall disagreement. This suggests that even where a policy exists, clear communication remains a significant concern. The finding also reflects Thornthwaite's (2016) argument that social media policies are often vague or poorly communicated, generating uncertainty rather than clarity for employees. This lack of policy

awareness and transparency provides important context for the perceptions of monitoring examined in the following section.

3.2 Perceptions of Monitoring and Privacy

Responses to the monitoring and privacy items indicate a broadly sceptical view of organisational monitoring. As shown in Figure 3, respondents tended to agree that monitoring employees' personal social media activity constitutes an invasion of privacy, with a mean score of 3.48. They also agreed more clearly that such practices create a culture of mistrust, which recorded a mean of 3.73 and the lowest standard deviation in this question set ($SD = 0.85$), indicating a relatively consistent view across the sample. In contrast, respondents leaned toward disagreement with the statement that employers have the right to monitor employees' personal social media activity, which produced a mean score of 2.62. Similarly, the claim that monitoring improves the organisation's reputation received a near neutral mean of 2.94, suggesting limited support for reputational arguments in favour of monitoring.



Across these items, respondents appeared generally unconvinced by broad organisational justifications for monitoring. The fact that mistrust produced both a comparatively high mean and the lowest variation across responses is particularly notable, as it indicates that this concern was broadly shared across the sample rather than confined to a particular subgroup. This pattern aligns with Suen's (2018) finding that employer monitoring of social media increases perceived privacy violation and reduces procedural justice, as well as with Stoughton et al.'s (2015)

argument that even limited forms of online screening can damage perceptions of organisational legitimacy.

At the same time, respondents did not reject employer intervention altogether. The strongest result in the entire survey came from the statement that employers should only intervene when an employee's post directly affects the organisation, which produced a mean score of 4.00 (SD = 0.97). This is analytically significant because it reveals a clear distinction in how respondents understood legitimacy. Monitoring was not viewed to be acceptable as a managerial right, but it was seen as more legitimate when linked to direct organisational relevance. Consequently, the contrast between Q9a and Q9c is important: respondents rejected routine or unrestricted monitoring, while accepting intervention where a clear organisational impact could be identified. This supports Hosain et al.'s (2025) finding that action against non-job-related posts is perceived as less fair. This conditional acceptance is tested more directly through scenario-based findings in the following section.

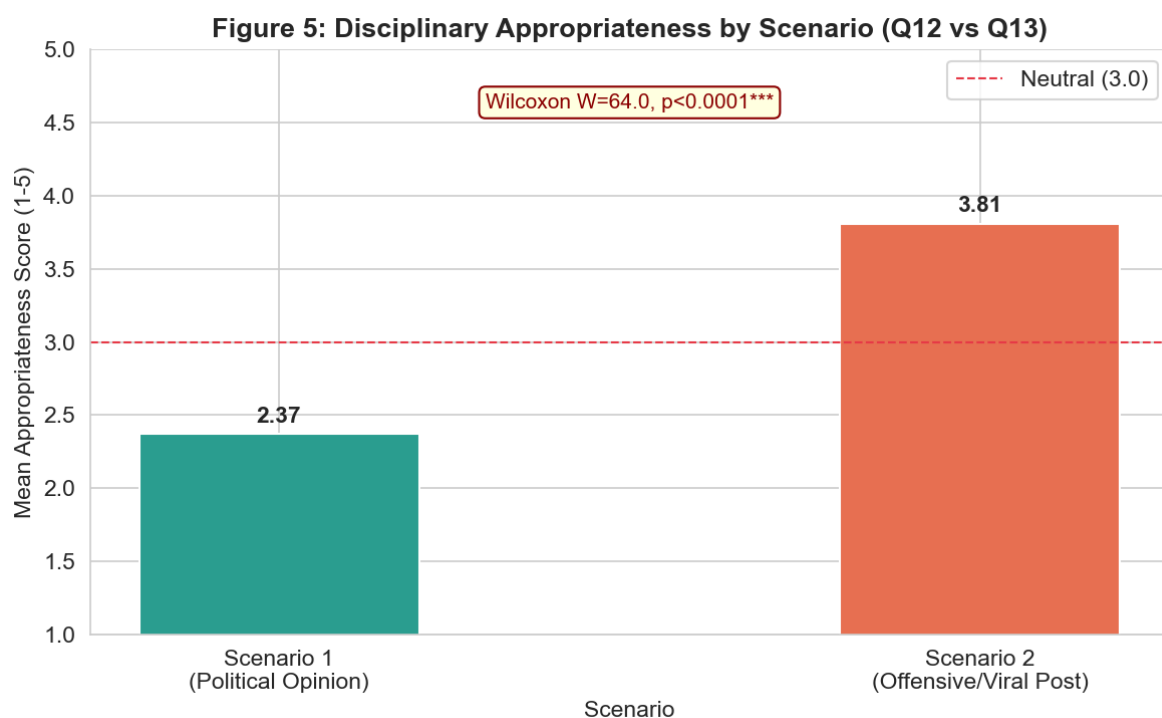
3.3 Disciplinary Legitimacy and Scenario Comparison

General attitudes toward disciplinary action were mixed when considered in isolation. As shown in Appendix C, the statement that it is appropriate for an employer to discipline an employee for inappropriate social media posts produced a mean score of 3.00, indicating a perfectly neutral overall result. However, this neutral mean masked genuine division rather than indifference. In total, 25 respondents agreed or strongly agreed, 19 remained neutral, and 19 disagreed or strongly disagreed. A similar pattern appeared concerning whether disciplinary action, taken in response to employees' personal social media activity, is usually proportionate to the situation. This item produced a mean score of 3.24, indicating a slight lean toward agreement, though the large number of neutral responses suggests continued uncertainty rather than strong endorsement.

This ambiguity is analytically important. Rather than showing a settled view on employer discipline, the findings suggest that respondents were divided when asked to consider the issue in the abstract. The high level of neutral responses on the proportionality item may also reflect respondents' limited direct exposure to such situations. As discussed later in the chapter, most respondents reported they had neither witnessed nor personally experienced disciplinary action related to personal

social media use. This pattern closely reflects Thompson et al.'s (2020) finding that employees often hold mixed views, simultaneously recognising that employers may have grounds to discipline certain forms of online behaviour while also believing that workers should retain freedom to express themselves.

However, when respondents were presented with specific scenarios, their views divided sharply. In Scenario 1, where an employee posted a political opinion on their personal social media account, outside of work hours, without mentioning their employer, disciplinary action was generally viewed as inappropriate. This scenario produced a mean score of 2.37, below the neutral midpoint. Conversely, Scenario 2, in which an employee posted offensive language that attracted significant public attention and negative comments directed at the employer, produced a mean score of 3.81, indicating that discipline was generally viewed as appropriate. As shown in Figure 5, this difference was tested using a Wilcoxon signed-rank test, which found a highly statistically significant difference between responses to the two scenarios ($W = 64$, $p < 0.0001$).



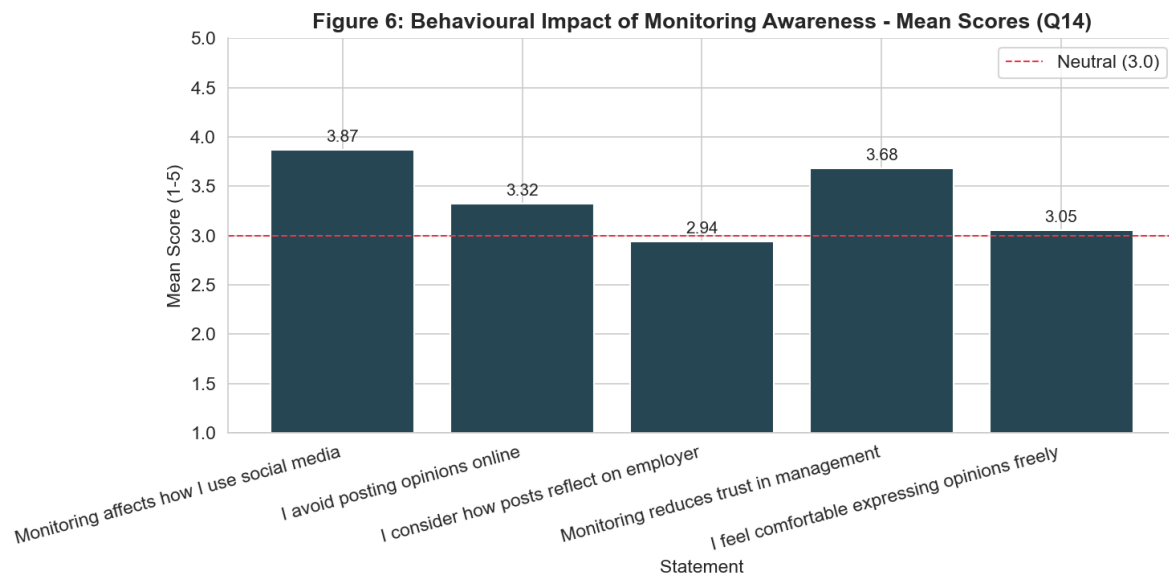
This represents the most pronounced finding within the disciplinary data. The same respondents who were neutral on discipline in principle, showed a strong and statistically significant divergence once context was introduced. This indicates that

legitimacy judgements were shaped less by abstract principles and more by the nature of the conduct in question. This directly supports the dissertation's hypothesis that moral severity and job-relatedness influence perceived legitimacy of disciplinary action. It also aligns closely with Cook and Kuhn's (2020) argument that fairness judgements are filtered through moral interpretation, as well as with Hosain et al.'s (2025) finding that action against non-job-related posts is viewed less favourably than intervention in cases involving clear harm or organisational impact. Scenario 2 also reflects the type of reputational 'firestorm' described by Bhargava (2020), suggesting that respondents were more accepting of discipline where public backlash and damage to the organisation were visible.

Therefore, the scenario findings suggest that respondents were not opposed to disciplinary action itself, but applied a clear harm and relevance threshold when judging its legitimacy. Political expression without a direct organisational link was viewed as overreach, whereas offensive content generating reputational harm was seen as a legitimate basis for intervention. These disciplinary perceptions do not exist in isolation, and the following section examines whether they are accompanied by broader behavioural changes in how respondents use social media.

3.4. Behavioural Impact and Employee Experience

Beyond disciplinary perceptions, the findings suggest that awareness of monitoring has a measurable impact on how respondents use social media. As shown in Figure 6, the statement that awareness of organisational monitoring affects how respondents use their personal social media, produced a mean score of 3.87, making it one of the strongest results in the survey. Respondents also leaned toward agreement with the statement that they avoid posting certain opinions because of concern that employers may see them, which recorded a mean of 3.32. In contrast, the statement that respondents actively consider how their posts may reflect on their employer, produced a near neutral mean of 2.94. These results suggest that awareness of monitoring shapes employee behaviour even in the absence of explicit policies or formal communication.



This pattern points toward a form of self-censorship. Respondents appeared to modify their behaviour in anticipation of possible scrutiny, even though earlier findings showed that most were unaware of any formal monitoring policy. This closely reflects Thornthwaite's (2016) argument that social media governance can create a 'chilling effect' on employee expression, as well as Robards and Graf's (2022) suggestion that workers internalise behavioural expectations through a wider culture of surveillance. The near neutral result on whether respondents actively consider their employer when posting is also interesting, as it suggests that this behavioural restraint may be more instinctive than consciously framed around organisational reputation.

Monitoring was also associated with reduced trust. The statement that awareness of monitoring reduces trust in management, produced a mean score of 3.68, which closely mirrors the earlier finding that *monitoring creates a culture of mistrust* (mean = 3.73). This consistency across two different question sets strengthens the interpretation that mistrust is a recurring theme in respondents' perceptions. At the same time, respondents remained broadly neutral on whether they felt comfortable expressing themselves freely on personal social media, with a mean of 3.05. This suggests a degree of uncertainty rather than a complete rejection of self-expression. Finally, these findings should be read alongside respondents' limited direct experience of disciplinary action: 51 respondents (81%) reported that they had neither witnessed nor experienced it, while 12 (19%) had witnessed it, and none had personally experienced it. This helps explain the earlier uncertainty around

proportionality in Section 3.3, as many respondents were judging such issues without direct exposure. While the quantitative findings reveal clear patterns in attitudes and behaviour, the open-ended responses provide further depth by capturing respondents' own explanations for these views, which are examined in the following section.

4. Qualitative Findings

Open-ended responses from Questions 16, 17, and 18 provided additional depth to the quantitative findings, with three dominant themes emerging across the dataset: the public/private distinction, job-relatedness and organisational impact, and transparency and policy clarity. Across all three questions, respondents did not view organisational monitoring as either wholly legitimate or wholly illegitimate. Instead, their judgements were conditional and shaped by how content was accessed, whether the post had a direct connection to the workplace, and whether organisations were open and explicit about their expectations.

4.1 The Public/Private Distinction

A particularly strong theme concerned the distinction between public and private social media activity. References to public or private visibility appeared in over 20 responses to Question 16, indicating that respondents attached considerable importance to whether content had been made openly accessible by the employee. One respondent stated, "I think that anything posted for the general public to see is fair game. It would be unfair if companies are making fake accounts and friend requesting employees to access their private posts." Another similarly noted that "If it's a public account, even if something is posted outside work hours...that individual still represents the organization."

These responses suggest that respondents were willing to accept a degree of monitoring where an employee had chosen to make content publicly visible. But they viewed access to private content through deceptive means as crossing a clear ethical boundary. This extends the earlier quantitative findings by suggesting that legitimacy depends not only on why an employer intervenes, but also on how information is obtained. In this respect, respondents appeared to recognise the blurred boundary between personal and professional identity online as described by

Ollier-Malaterre (2023), while still insisting that some distinction between public visibility and private access should remain.

4.2 Job-Relatedness and Harm Threshold

A second dominant theme concerned job-relatedness and the threshold of harm required to justify intervention. Responses to Question 17 frequently referred to the company, the workplace, organisational values, reputation, or harm caused to others. This strongly reinforces the quantitative finding that respondents were most accepting of intervention when an employee's post directly affected the organisation. One respondent stated that intervention was appropriate, "Only if it is directly impacting the company, and firing the employee should not be the first resort." Another offered an even more comprehensive formulation: "It is appropriate...when an employee's personal social media activity clearly affects the workplace...However, employers should be cautious about intervening in cases where the activity is purely personal, lawful, and unrelated to the employee's role." A further respondent emphasised proportionality, stating that "If an employee posted a couple of times...there should be a meeting, a warning, and then if anything else repeats, then disciplinary action."

These responses are notable because they independently articulate the same harm and relevance threshold that emerged in the scenario-based findings. They also show that respondents were not simply asking whether discipline was justified, but how far it should go. The repeated emphasis on warnings, meetings, and escalation before dismissal suggests that proportionality was central to perceptions of fairness. This closely reflects Sia et al.'s (2021) finding that disciplinary responses are viewed as more legitimate where conduct involves clear harm, disruption, or reputational damage rather than ambiguous personal expression.

4.3 Transparency and Policy Clarity

The third major theme concerned transparency and policy clarity, which was the most prominent improvement-oriented theme in responses to Question 18. Many respondents explicitly stated that monitoring would feel fairer if policies were clearer, more transparent, and communicated earlier. One respondent wrote, "Have a transparent policy addressed during the onboarding process so future employees are more aware," while another captured the underlying concern more concisely:

“what people don’t know, they often fear”. This was reinforced by a further response which stated that “transparency...I feel it is common place for companies to have little-no documentation on social media monitoring and a little transparency goes a long way.” Another respondent added that organisations should “ensure they are only being monitored for ill suited posts not every day ones...make it clear that it isn’t to punish people who haven’t done anything wrong.”

These responses strongly support the earlier quantitative findings on policy awareness and behavioural self-censorship. In particular, the observation that “what people don’t know, they often fear” helps explain why respondents reported modifying their behaviour, despite often being unsure whether monitoring was actually occurring. The issue was not simply surveillance itself, but uncertainty surrounding its scope, purpose, and limits. This aligns closely with Bhawe et al.’s (2020) argument that monitoring is perceived as less invasive when individuals understand what is being collected, why it is relevant, and how it may be used.

Overall, the qualitative responses reinforce and extend the quantitative findings, suggesting that monitoring legitimacy is conditional on how content is accessed, whether organisational relevance is clear, and whether policies are communicated transparently. These themes form the basis for the discussion presented in the following section.

5. Discussion

The findings presented across this chapter show that respondents did not evaluate organisational monitoring and disciplinary action in absolute terms. Rather than treating such practices as inherently fair or unfair, they applied a more conditional framework shaped by privacy expectations, organisational relevance, and the clarity with which policies were communicated. When interpreted against the three hypotheses set out in the methodology, the results suggest partial support for the first hypothesis and strong support for the second and third.

The first hypothesis proposed that perceived monitoring would be associated with heightened privacy concerns and reduced trust. This was partially supported. Quantitative findings did indicate clear concern in both respects: respondents leaned toward agreement that monitoring constituted an invasion of privacy (mean = 3.48),

while mistrust emerged consistently across two separate question sets, with mean scores of 3.73 and 3.68. This broadly supports Suen's (2018) argument that employer monitoring heightens privacy violation and weakens procedural justice, as well as Stoughton et al.'s (2015) finding that even limited online screening can damage organisational legitimacy. However, the qualitative findings suggest a more nuanced picture than the hypothesis initially implied. Respondents were not uniformly opposed to monitoring itself. Instead, many drew a clear distinction between publicly visible content, which was often considered fair game, and private content accessed deceptively, which was viewed as illegitimate. Accordingly, the findings suggest that it is not monitoring itself that triggers privacy concerns and reduced trust, but monitoring that is opaque, poorly communicated, or disproportionate. In this sense, the results refine rather than simply confirm the existing literature.

The second hypothesis, that transparency moderates these effects, was strongly supported. Earlier findings showed that policy communication was weak, with respondents overall disagreeing that social media policies were clearly communicated (mean = 2.48). This was reinforced powerfully in the qualitative responses, where transparency and policy clarity emerged as the most prominent improvement-oriented theme. As noted in the qualitative findings, respondents indicated that uncertainty itself drives fear, which helps explain why behavioural self-censorship appeared even where most respondents were unsure whether monitoring was actually taking place. This strongly confirms Bhawe et al.'s (2020) argument that monitoring is perceived as less invasive when individuals understand what is being collected and why it is relevant. It also supports Suen's (2018) finding that transparency improves justice perceptions, while extending Thornthwaite's (2016) argument by suggesting that vague policies do not merely create uncertainty, but actively intensify the fear and mistrust associated with monitoring. The inverse also appears true: where respondents could imagine monitoring as transparent and clearly governed, their opposition softened considerably.

The third hypothesis, that moral severity and job-relatedness influence perceived legitimacy of disciplinary action, was also strongly supported. This was the clearest finding in the chapter. The strongest mean score in the entire survey was attached to the statement that employers should only intervene when a post directly affects the

organisation (mean = 4.00). This was reinforced by the scenario comparison, where respondents judged discipline for a political opinion without a clear organisational link as inappropriate (mean = 2.37), but viewed discipline for offensive content causing public reputational harm as appropriate (mean = 3.81). The difference was highly statistically significant. The qualitative findings independently reproduced the same threshold, with repeated emphasis on harm, organisational impact, and proportionality. This strongly confirms Cook and Kuhn's (2020) argument that fairness judgements are filtered through moral interpretation, as well as Hosain et al.'s (2025) finding that intervention is viewed less favourably where posts are personal and unrelated to work. Scenario 2 also aligns with Bhargava's (2020) discussion of reputational 'firestorm' cases, where organisational intervention becomes more widely accepted once visible harm is created.

Overall, the findings point to one consistent principle across all three hypotheses: respondents were not opposed to monitoring in principle, but judged its legitimacy according to transparency, job-relatedness, and proportionality. This suggests that the key issue is not simply whether monitoring occurs, but how it is governed, communicated, and applied. The implications of this for organisational practice are considered in the following section.

6. Contribution and Implications

The findings make both a theoretical and practical contribution to understanding how employees evaluate social media monitoring. While prior studies often present monitoring as inherently invasive or trust-damaging, the present findings suggest a more conditional relationship. Respondents were not uniformly opposed to monitoring itself; instead, concerns intensified where monitoring was perceived as opaque, disproportionate, or directed toward private content. In this respect, the study extends existing work by showing that legitimacy depends not simply on whether monitoring occurs, but on how it is governed, communicated, and applied. It also provides empirical support for the privacy calculus proposed in the literature by showing that transparency, job-relatedness, and proportionality shape both behavioural responses and disciplinary judgements in practice.

From a practical perspective, the findings suggest that organisations should adopt explicit standalone social media policies rather than relying on vague contractual

wording. These policies should be communicated clearly during onboarding and reinforced periodically throughout employment. They should distinguish between public and private content, define what constitutes direct organisational impact, and provide examples of acceptable and unacceptable conduct. In particular, policies should explicitly distinguish between protected personal expression, such as political opinions, and content that causes demonstrable organisational harm. They should also explain the organisation's values and broader expectations around representation, so that employees understand how certain forms of online conduct may conflict with those values even where the employer is not directly named.

Policies should further specify the nature and frequency of monitoring, whether active, routine, or complaint-driven, so that employees understand the scope of organisational oversight rather than fearing undefined surveillance. In addition, an educational component is important. By clearly educating employees on expectations, organisational values, and how online behaviour may reflect on both the employee and the organisation, firms may not only increase perceptions of fairness and legitimacy, but may also reduce the likelihood of harmful incidents occurring in the first place. Finally, a staged disciplinary model should be adopted, with warnings and relevant training preceding stronger sanctions, except in severe cases. Notwithstanding these contributions, the study has several limitations that should be considered when interpreting the findings, which are outlined in the following section.

7. Limitations and Future Research

The sample size of 63 valid respondents was modest and obtained through convenience sampling, which likely contributed to the overrepresentation of shorter-tenured and non-managerial employees identified earlier in the chapter. This limits the extent to which the findings can be generalised to more senior or longer-tenured employee populations. Moreover, due to the anonymous nature of the survey, demographic characteristics such as geographic location, cultural background, and age, could not be captured or controlled for, which may limit the generalisability of the findings across different national or cultural contexts. Finally, as the study relied on self-reported survey data, the findings reflect perceptions and stated attitudes rather than observed behaviour in actual workplace situations.

Two directions for future research emerge from these findings. First, while both the present study and the wider literature suggest that employees are more accepting of intervention where there is clear organisational harm, little attention has been paid to how such harm should be measured or assessed in practice. Future research could explore the development of standardised harm assessment frameworks that could guide organisational decision-making more consistently and transparently. Second, further research could examine how informal workplace relationships, such as colleagues or work friends, connected on private accounts, create secondary forms of surveillance that blur the public/private distinction employees rely on when judging fairness. Addressing these gaps would further develop understanding of how fairness perceptions are shaped in digitally mediated workplaces, and contribute to the development of more effective and equitable organisational monitoring practices.

Critical Reflection

This chapter of the dissertation required me to design and carry out an independent piece of primary research, analyse the findings, and interpret them in relation to the existing literature. From the outset, I wanted to produce a project that felt both academically meaningful and particularly relevant. I was interested in a topic that sat at the intersection of organisational policy, employee fairness, and contemporary workplace realities. In retrospect, this project was one of the most engaging and rewarding components of my degree programme.

One of the most challenging aspects of the project was data collection. I had originally hoped to achieve closer to 100 survey responses, so reaching 63 valid respondents felt slightly lower than I had intended. However, this process also taught me an important lesson about balancing quantity and quality in primary research. Although the sample was more modest than planned, many of the open-ended responses were thoughtful, specific, and analytically useful. The richness of the qualitative data helped compensate for the more limited scale of the survey. If I were to conduct this project again, I would aim to broaden my sampling strategy beyond my immediate networks to increase the number and diversity of respondents, particularly among more senior and longer-tenured employees.

What made this project especially meaningful was that it brought together several strands of my academic and professional development. During my Winter/Spring 2025 internship, I worked as an HR Business Partner Intern in a large organisation. A significant part of that role involved working with data, dashboards, and organisational insights, which first sparked my interest in data analytics. As a result, I chose to specialise in data analytics this year and developed a range of new technical skills, including Python. This dissertation created a full-circle moment for me: I was able to use Python to preprocess, categorise, and analyse my own primary research data while working on a topic closely related to organisational policy and employee fairness. That felt particularly rewarding, as it showed me that the skills I had developed were directly applicable to real organisational questions.

The project also strengthened my confidence in carrying out independent research from start to finish. I developed a better understanding of how to translate a broad topic into a focused research question, design a survey aligned with a clear

methodological approach, and connect theoretical frameworks to real empirical findings. Using Python added a further level of analytical depth that I would not have achieved as effectively otherwise. More broadly, the dissertation deepened my understanding of organisational justice, social media governance, and employee perceptions of fairness in ways that extended beyond what the literature alone could have provided.

If I were to extend this research further, I would be interested in pursuing some of the future research gaps identified in the dissertation, particularly how organisational harm could be assessed more consistently and how informal workplace relationships may create secondary forms of surveillance outside formal monitoring policies. I would also consider using a mixed-methods approach, combining survey research with interviews, to capture richer individual experiences alongside broader patterns. Overall, this dissertation has been one of the most personally and academically rewarding projects I have undertaken, and it has reinforced my interest in pursuing a career at the intersection of people management and data analytics.

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Appendix A: Sample Demographics

Figure 1a: Respondents by Sector

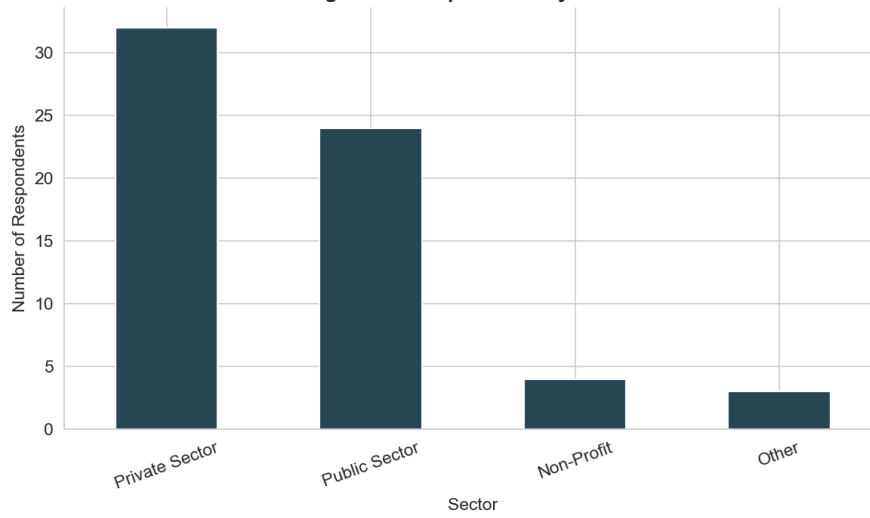


Figure 1b: Respondents by Length of Employment

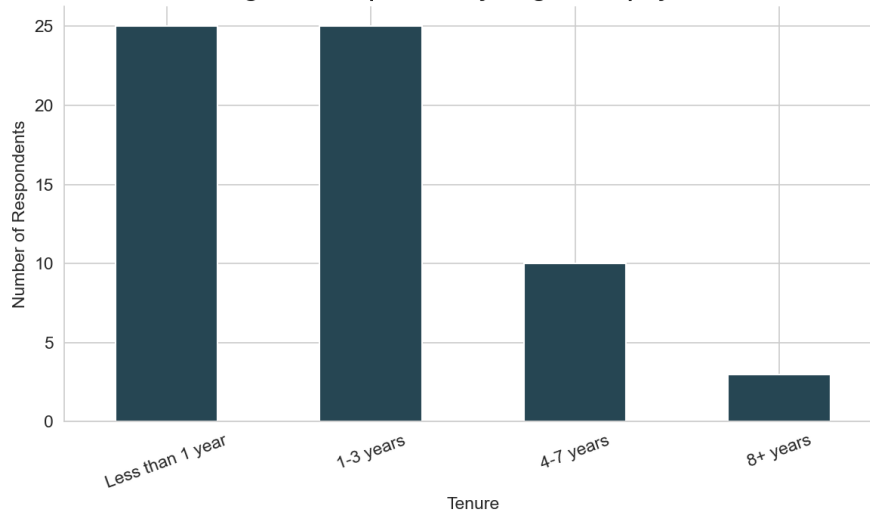
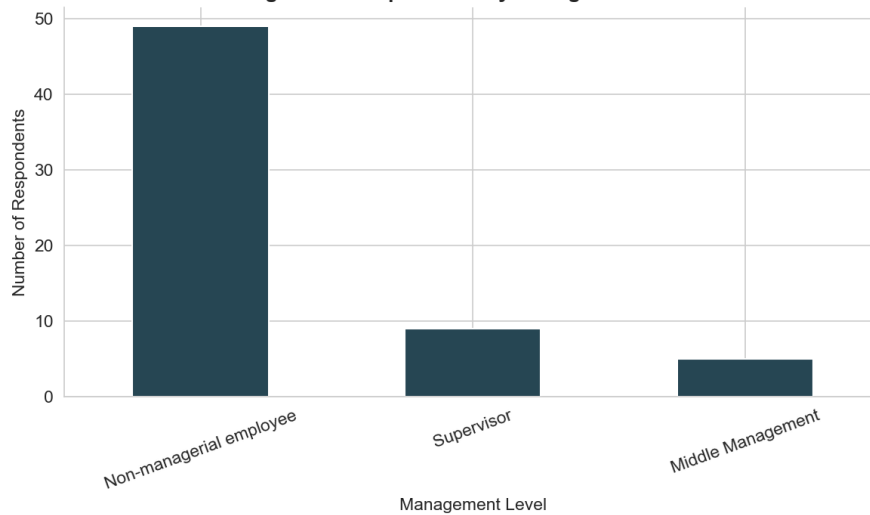


Figure 1c: Respondents by Management Level



Appendix B: Policy Awareness Figures

Figure 2a: Does Your Organisation Have a Social Media Policy? (Q

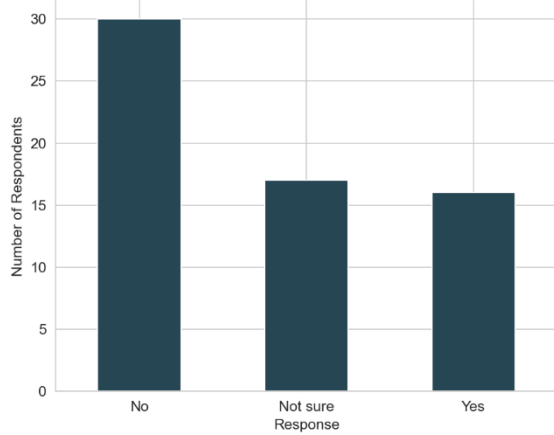


Figure 2b: Does Your Organisation Monitor Social Media Activity? (I

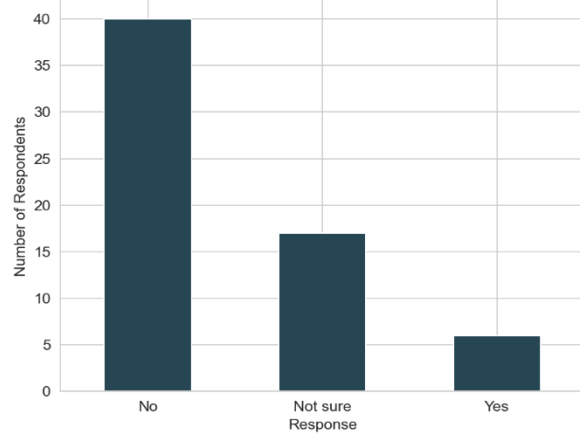
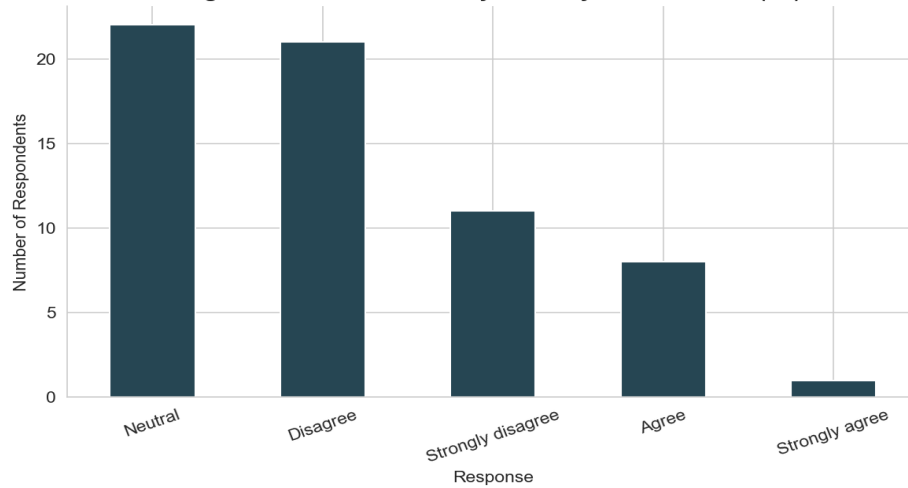
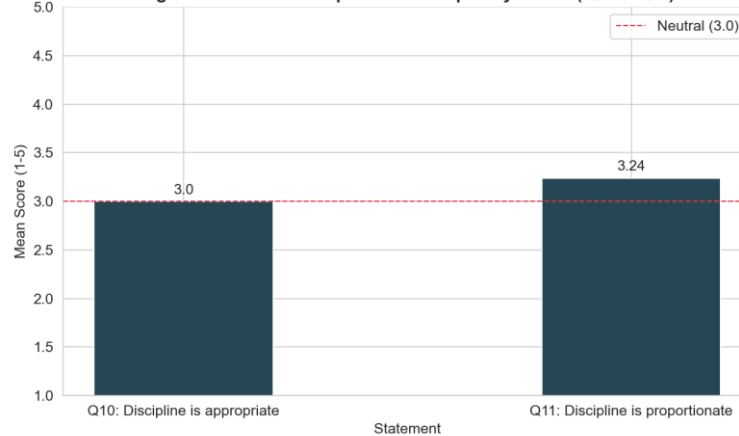


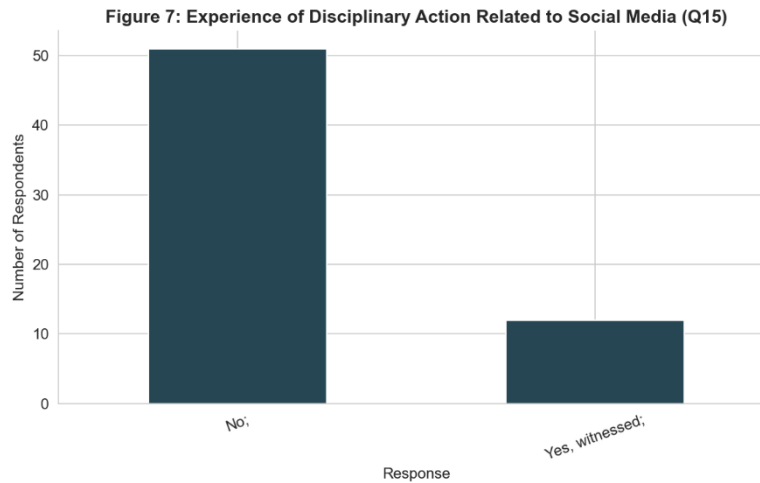
Figure 2c: Social Media Policy is Clearly Communicated (Q8)



Appendix C: Supplementary Figures

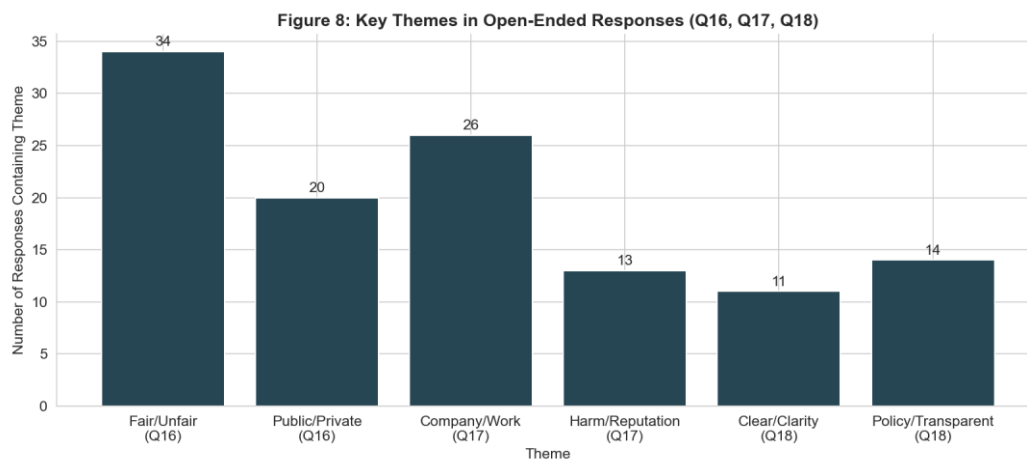
Figure 4: General Perceptions of Disciplinary Action (Q10 & Q11)





Descriptive Statistics Summary Table:

Question	Mean	Std Dev
Q8: Policy clearly communicated	2.48	0.98
Q9a: Right to monitor public SM	2.62	1.08
Q9b: Monitoring = invasion of privacy	3.48	1.15
Q9c: Only intervene if affects org	4	0.97
Q9d: Monitoring improves reputation	2.94	1.05
Q9e: Creates culture of mistrust	3.73	0.85
Q10: Discipline is appropriate	3	1.05
Q11: Discipline is proportionate	3.24	0.78
Q12: Scenario 1 - Political opinion	2.37	1.22
Q13: Scenario 2 - Offensive/viral post	3.81	1.34
Q14a: Monitoring affects usage	3.87	1.02
Q14b: Avoid posting opinions	3.32	1.2
Q14c: Consider employer reflection	2.94	1.29
Q14d: Monitoring reduces trust	3.68	1.01
Q14e: Comfortable expressing freely	3.05	1.05



Appendix D: Data Analysis Process

Survey data were analysed using Python in Visual Studio Code (VSCode). This tool was selected because it allowed the data to be cleaned, coded, analysed, and visualised within a single environment, while also providing greater flexibility than spreadsheet-based analysis alone. Before analysis, the dataset was preprocessed to remove invalid responses that did not meet the study's employment and consent criteria. Variables were then renamed for clarity, and categorical and Likert-scale responses were encoded into consistent numerical formats to support statistical analysis.

For the quantitative component, descriptive statistics were generated to summarise demographic characteristics, policy awareness, monitoring perceptions, disciplinary legitimacy, and behavioural impact. Mean scores were calculated for Likert-scale items to identify overall response patterns. In addition, a Wilcoxon signed-rank test was used to compare responses to the two disciplinary scenarios, as these involved paired ordinal data from the same respondents. This allowed the study to test whether differences in scenario judgements were statistically significant.

For the qualitative component, open-ended responses were reviewed and grouped through keyword frequency analysis to identify recurring themes across Questions 16, 17, and 18. The analysis process also produced a summary statistics table and visual figures used throughout the findings sections and appendices. Limited AI assistance was used to support coding syntax and troubleshooting, while all analytical decisions, interpretations, and written discussion remained my own.

Appendix E: Generative AI Declaration Statement

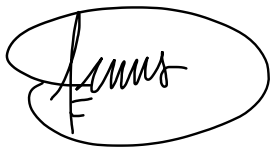
Declaration Statement

Please tick the appropriate box relating to your use of Gen AI tools for this dissertation.

A. ☐ I did not use any Gen AI tools (including for editing and proofreading) in the completion of this assignment

B. ☒ I did use Gen AI tools in the completion of this assignment

Signature: Dennis Chumakov

A handwritten signature in black ink, enclosed within an oval border. The signature appears to be 'Dennis Chumakov' written in a cursive, stylized script.

Date: 14/04/2026

Appendix F: Reporting of Gen AI Tool Use in Assignment

Tools: I used Gemini (Google) 3.1 Pro between 1st April 2026 and 14th April 2026.

Outputs: I did not use any direct AI-generated text in this assignment. Gemini was used as an interactive coding assistant and structural guide. Importantly, no raw survey data was shared with Gemini at any point; all data remained within my local Python environment. All analytical decisions, interpretations, and written content are my own work.

Example Prompts & Outputs by Category:

1. Python Coding Assistance

- *Prompt:* Requests for help with specific Python syntax for data cleaning, encoding, statistical testing, and visualisation.
- *Output:* Gemini provided code blocks which I typed independently into VSCode, ran, debugged, and adapted. All analytical decisions about what to analyse and how to interpret results were my own.

2. Structural Guidance

- *Prompt:* Explained the overall format of each section, the data I wanted to include, the connection to past literature and what the findings mean. Requested that Gemini structure this into a PPC-structured outline.
- *Output:* Gemini provided structured outlines for each section based on my input information, allowing me to stay on track while writing. All writing was drafted independently by me; the overall structure and formatting are my own.

3. Feedback on Drafted Sections

- *Prompt:* Pasted independently written paragraph drafts and asked: "Can you review this and identify where I could potentially strengthen academic tone, structure, and completeness, and check that I am not missing anything from the outline for this section?"
- *Output:* Gemini identified areas where tone, structure, or completeness could be strengthened. No content was rewritten by Gemini; all revisions were made by me independently.

4. Conceptual Clarification

- *Prompt:* Questions about methodological concepts such as the Wilcoxon signed-rank test.
- *Output:* Gemini explained concepts in plain language to support my understanding. All claims were independently verified, and the application of these concepts to the research was my own.

Iterations: Several sessions between the 1st of April and 14th April 2026, covering Python coding assistance, structural guidance, feedback on drafted sections, and conceptual clarification as outlined above.

Critical Reflection: I used Gemini responsibly as a coding assistant and feedback tool rather than a content generator. All data analysis decisions, written arguments, critical thinking, and interpretations remained entirely my own. Gemini's role was to support the technical execution of the analysis and provide structural guidance. No raw survey data was shared with Gemini at any point; all data remained within my local Python environment, and all intellectual content was independently produced.